Assignment 2 — Grading Rubric (100 points = 10% of final course grade)

#	Criterion	Points	Excellent	Proficient	Developing	Inadequate
1	**Hypothesis set quality**	15	All 4 given hypotheses addressed; added hypothesis is genuinely distinct, specific, and plausible given the scenario	Added hypothesis is plausible but somewhat generic or overlaps partly with a given one	Added hypothesis is a reworded version of an existing one, or is vague/unfalsifiable	No hypothesis added, or hypothesis set is incomplete
2	**Evidence use and sourcing**	15	All 11 evidence items addressed in the matrix; any added evidence/assumptions are clearly labelled as the student's own	Nearly all evidence items addressed; minor omissions or unclear labelling of added material	Several evidence items missing, ignored, or misread	Matrix addresses only a handful of evidence items, or evidence is fabricated/contradicts the scenario
3	**ACH matrix construction (C/I/NA ratings)**	20	Every cell rated; ratings are logically defensible and consistent with each other; non-obvious ratings are briefly justified	Matrix complete; one or two ratings are questionable or unjustified but the overall matrix is sound	Matrix has multiple internally inconsistent or unsupported ratings	Matrix is incomplete, or ratings appear essentially random / not reasoned
4	**Diagnosticity and inconsistency analysis**	20	Explicitly identifies the most diagnostic evidence (item 6 and/or item 9 are the clearest candidates) and explains why; correctly notes when an item is weakly diagnostic (consistent with everything); inconsistency tally used to inform, not dictate, the conclusion	Identifies some diagnostic evidence correctly but reasoning is thinner, or over-relies on raw inconsistency counts without discussing why	Treats all evidence as roughly equally important; little or no discussion of diagnosticity	No diagnosticity discussion; conclusion is asserted without reference to which evidence drove it
5	**Conclusion, confidence, and honesty about uncertainty**	20	Clear best-supported hypothesis (or an explicit, well-argued case for a compound/hybrid explanation), stated confidence level matches the actual strength of the evidence, genuine sensitivity point identified, concrete monitoring indicator(s) given	Conclusion is reasonable and evidence-based but confidence level is somewhat mismatched (overclaimed or underclaimed), or sensitivity/monitoring sections are thin	Conclusion is asserted with much more or much less certainty than the evidence supports; little genuine sensitivity analysis	No clear conclusion, or conclusion ignores the matrix entirely (e.g., picks a hypothesis the evidence does not support and does not address the contrary evidence)
6	**Structure, clarity, and analytic writing**	10	Report follows the required structure exactly; word count stated and within 1,200–1,800; writing is clear, analytic (not narrative/story-telling), and free of unsupported claims	Mostly follows structure; word count close to range or stated inaccurately; generally clear writing	Structure partially followed; word count noticeably outside range; writing is unclear or more narrative than analytic in places	Structure not followed; word count far outside range or not stated; writing is unclear throughout

Total: 100 points.

Notes for students

- There is no single “correct” hypothesis that earns automatic full marks. Two students can reach different conclusions and both score well, provided their reasoning is transparent, evidence-based, and honest about uncertainty. Conversely, landing on an instructor-anticipated conclusion for the wrong reasons (e.g., by ignoring contrary evidence) will not earn full marks on criteria 3–5.
- Criterion 4 (diagnosticity) and criterion 5 (conclusion/confidence) together are worth 40% of this assignment’s grade. This is deliberate: the point of ACH is the reasoning about *which* evidence matters and *why*, not simply filling in a grid.
- The late policy and academic integrity requirements are described in `assignment2_brief.md` and are not part of this rubric’s point allocation; a late deduction is applied to the total after scoring, and an academic integrity concern is handled outside of this rubric entirely.